

PROSPER AWUNI

Information Security Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am an experienced Information Security (InfoSec) Engineer and Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of dedicated hands-on experience building and enhancing blue team capabilities, including threat hunting, detection engineering, Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) operations, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) administration, and vulnerability management. I have a strong track record of designing, deploying, and hardening security configurations across large enterprise environments, monitoring and responding to SIEM alerts, improving detection quality through iterative rule tuning, and reducing false positives to maintain a focused and effective alert queue. I have worked closely with third-party EDR, SIEM and SOAR vendors, Data Loss Prevention (DLP), and Secure Web Gateway (SWG) providers to improve security tooling, and I regularly advise on security architecture, vendor selection, and service improvements. I have led Tier 3 incident response, built SOAR playbooks using Logic Apps and PowerShell, and conducted proactive threat hunting using the MITRE ATT&CK framework. I am seeking an InfoSec Engineer role where I can contribute this breadth of experience to build and mature threat detection and blue team capabilities in a dynamic, technology-led organisation.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM / SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel (Kusto Query Language / KQL), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM); detection rule authoring, analytics rules, Logic Apps SOAR playbooks, workbooks, data connectors, alert tuning and false positive reduction
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Insight, Discover (Expert); Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender; Tanium
- **Threat Hunting:** Proactive hypothesis-driven threat hunting across endpoint, identity, cloud, and email telemetry using KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight; MITRE ATT&CK-mapped hunting queries
- **Security Configuration and Hardening:** Azure and Entra ID security baselines, Conditional Access policy design, CIS Controls benchmarking, device hardening via Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus; vulnerability scanning, assessment, and risk-prioritised remediation
- **Data Loss Prevention (DLP) and Secure Web Gateway (SWG):** DLP policy management; web filtering and gateway security policy administration; Mimecast email security
- **Security Architecture Advice:** Vendor evaluation and selection, tooling improvement recommendations, third-party managed service oversight and governance
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK, senior escalation lead, playbook authoring, Tier 3 investigation
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM platform administration; least-privilege enforcement
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, Logic Apps, SOAR playbook engineering
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer — University of the Arts London (UAL) *March 2025 – Present*

- Build and continuously enhance blue team and threat hunting capabilities across the UAL IT estate, using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL) to conduct hypothesis-driven hunting and uncover threats not surfaced by automated detections.

- Design, deploy, and harden security configurations across endpoint, identity, cloud, and email environments, applying CIS Controls benchmarks, Conditional Access policies, and Microsoft Intune compliance baselines to reduce the attack surface.
- Monitor and investigate Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) alerts from Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM) across 8,000+ users and endpoints, triaging, enriching, and escalating events in line with defined response procedures.
- Improve detection quality through continuous rule tuning, authoring and refining analytics rules and Kusto Query Language (KQL) queries mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, significantly reducing false positives while maintaining high-confidence detection coverage.
- Develop and maintain Logic Apps Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks and PowerShell automation to accelerate alert enrichment, triage, and containment, and to reduce analyst workload on repetitive response actions.
- Work with third-party managed security service providers and tool vendors (EDR, SIEM/SOAR, Secure Web Gateway, Data Loss Prevention) to improve tooling, drive service improvements, and inform strategic vendor selection decisions.
- Advise on security architecture improvements, evaluating new technologies, proposing tooling enhancements, and supporting security roadmap development in partnership with senior leadership.
- Manage vulnerability scanning and assessment using Pentra Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Nessus; coordinate risk-prioritised remediation with technical teams.
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) and Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) security controls, enforcing least-privilege access and monitoring privileged activity.
- Serve as senior escalation lead for Tier 3 security incidents, leading end-to-end investigations using NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity — University of the Arts London (UAL)

March 2022 – March 2025

- Performed day-to-day SIEM alert monitoring, triage, and investigation across Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Falcon, and Microsoft Defender platforms.
- Managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender operations across an 8,000-user estate, including alert investigation and response coordination.
- Contributed to detection rule development and alert tuning within Microsoft Sentinel, working iteratively to improve detection fidelity and reduce false positives.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning using Nessus, produced risk-prioritised remediation reports, and tracked remediation closure with infrastructure teams.
- Supported Tier 2 incident response and contributed to post-incident documentation and lessons-learned reviews that informed improvements to detection and response procedures.
- Assisted in the administration of Azure Active Directory, MFA, Conditional Access, and group policy, supporting identity and access security across the organisation.
- Contributed to Cyber Essentials+, ISO 27001, and CIS Controls compliance activities, security policy development, and audit evidence preparation.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure — HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 – March 2022

- Managed security controls and infrastructure operations within a regulated SaaS and FinTech environment handling sensitive supplier and procurement data for global enterprises.
- Administered access management, monitored security events, and supported vulnerability remediation and patch management activities.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 compliance activities and external and internal audit preparation.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and continuously matured blue team and threat hunting capabilities at UAL using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel KQL, delivering meaningful improvements in proactive threat detection and reduction of attacker dwell time.
- Designed and deployed the Microsoft Sentinel SIEM workspace from the ground up, authoring custom analytics rules and MITRE ATT&CK-mapped KQL detection queries, and significantly reducing false

positives through iterative tuning.

- Developed Logic Apps SOAR playbooks and PowerShell automation scripts that reduced manual alert handling by over 60%, enabling analysts to focus on higher-value investigations.
- Managed end-to-end vulnerability management using Pentera BAS, Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Nessus, coordinating risk-prioritised remediation and achieving sustained attack surface reduction each quarter.
- Advised on security tooling improvements and vendor selection across EDR, SIEM, and email security, supporting informed decisions on third-party security partnerships.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (Oxford/UK)